

GPU Troubleshooting Checklist for a Gaming PC

1. Identify the Symptoms

☐ Record the issue being experienced:

- No display or black screen
- Screen flickering or artifacts
- Game crashes or poor performance
- Driver errors or system freezes
- Unexpected shutdowns during gaming

☐ Check whether the problem occurs:

- During startup
 - Only while gaming
 - After a driver update
 - During normal desktop use
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2. Check Physical Connections

☐ Turn off the PC and disconnect power before inspecting hardware.

☐ Verify that:

- The GPU is fully seated in the PCIe slot.
- The GPU power connectors (6-pin/8-pin/12VHPWR, if applicable) are securely attached.
- The monitor cable is connected to the GPU output ports, not the motherboard ports.
- The display cable and monitor input source are working correctly.

3. Inspect GPU Condition and Cooling

☐ Check for:

- Dust buildup on the GPU fans and heatsink.
- Fans not spinning when the GPU is under load (if applicable).
- Unusual noises from the graphics card.
- Signs of overheating.

☐ Ensure proper airflow inside the PC case.

4. Verify and Update GPU Drivers

☐ Open Device Manager or the GPU management software.

☐ Check for:

- Driver errors or warning symbols.
- Incorrect GPU detection.

☐ Update or reinstall the graphics driver using the official GPU manufacturer software.

☐ Restart the PC after driver changes.

5. Test GPU Performance

☐ Run a game or GPU benchmark/stress test.

☐ Monitor:

- GPU temperature
- Clock speeds

- Usage percentage
- Crashes or graphical glitches

☐ Compare performance with expected results for the hardware.

6. Rule Out Software and System Issues

☐ Check for:

- Recent Windows updates or software changes.
- Conflicting overlays or background applications.
- Corrupted game files.

☐ Test with another game or application to determine whether the problem is GPU-related or software-specific.

7. Confirm the Fix

☐ Restart the PC and verify normal boot behavior.

☐ Confirm that:

- The display works correctly.
- Games run without crashes or artifacts.
- GPU drivers load properly.
- Temperatures remain within normal operating ranges.